

Bottleneck Solution Reference

Model Root Cause Analysis for ticket MB-14: Investigate a Defect Bottleneck. Open this only after you have written your own RCA.

TICKET MB-141 AT A GLANCE

Field	Value
Title	Enrollment Report Fails to Load for Blank Instructor ID
Component	Admin Reporting
Created / Resolved	2026-05-04 / 2026-05-18 (MTTR ~14 days)
Reopen count	2 (Cannot Reproduce on 2026-05-05 and 2026-05-08)
Eventual fix	A single input validation check on the Instructor ID field

WHAT WAS MISSING FROM THE ORIGINAL REPORT

Needed to reproduce	In the original report?	When it finally arrived
Environment (browser, OS, device)	No	Comment 2 (browser only); complete in Comment 4
Exact steps and the data condition (Instructor ID left blank)	No	Comment 4
Console error message	No	Comment 4 (console_error.png)

Every reopen maps directly to a missing detail. The fix only became possible once all three were provided together in Comment 4 — every day before that point was an avoidable delay.

MODEL ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS

The MTTR and Reopen Rate spiked because the original report gave the developer no way to reproduce the issue: it omitted the environment, the specific data condition (blank Instructor ID), and the console error. Without these details, the developer could only guess at the cause, leading to two "Cannot Reproduce" closures and two reopens before the actual fix was possible. The 14-day delay was not caused by a complex bug — it was caused by a one-line omission in the original report. Next time, I will use a pre-submission checklist that requires me to confirm I have included the environment, exact reproduction steps with specific data values, and any relevant console output before I submit a ticket.

HOW YOUR RCA IS ASSESSED

A strong RCA does two things:

Names the root cause precisely — the vague initial report (missing environment, missing exact steps and the blank Instructor ID data condition, missing console evidence) — not "the developer was slow" or "the bug was complex."

Proposes a concrete action plan — a repeatable pre-submission checklist or "Definition of Ready" standard that ensures future tickets carry the necessary information from the start.

Your wording will differ from the model, and that is expected. If your RCA identifies the specific communication breakdown and proposes at least two concrete, actionable improvements, you have met the goal of this activity. If your RCA focuses on the developer's behavior rather than the report quality, revisit the comment thread and count how many times the developer asked for information that should have been in the original report.